

Midterm Exam

ANTH-202 | Archaeology: Our Human Past

Instructor: Tracie Mayfield

Term: Fall 2026

Assignment Summary

Grade weight:	20%
Due date:	2026-10-13
Group project:	No

Overview (Grading breakdown)

midterm exam 20%

Assignment Description

4) 40% Midterm & Final Exams [20% each] (online, via Brightspace under ACTIVITIES>QUIZZES) - More information will be sent out about the exams during the semester. • Exams will be online (open book and open notes) and the final exam is NOT CUMULATIVE. • NOTE: OSAS students will automatically have their extra time added to the first part of the exam (if your paperwork has been submitted to the instructor at least two weeks before the exam). • All rules regarding plagiarism and AI use apply to the exam essay questions. See the sections on 'Plagiarism' & 'AI Use' below for more information. • NOTE: While studying together for the exam is encouraged, it is expected that you take the exams on your own. While the exams are open, you should not discuss the exam with anyone, seek answers from other students while taking the exam, or ask other students who have already taken the exam questions about the exam. • You CAN use your notes, any of the course materials, and even look up information online; but you will need to refrain from logging onto chat/discussion/messaging apps while the exam periods are open. • If you share information with other students or seek out answers to questions from other students (this includes being on chat and 'passively' getting information about the exam) while the exam window is open, you will receive a 0 on the exam. • MIDTERM EXAM (1 hour & 20 minutes) - see the course schedule below for date/time • 20-25 multiple choice & true/false questions • Utilize the weekly quizzes (most of the questions will come directly from the weekly quizzes), lectures, readings, & films, and study questions (in the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS) to prepare for this section of the exam. • 2 essay questions • Utilize the lab section exercises & discussions, lectures, readings, & films, and study questions (in the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS) to prepare for this section of the exam. • Suggested length that an average student needs to properly answer a short essay is approximately 500-800 words PER ESSAY QUESTION, but note that credit is based on content quality, use of professional language (specific to anthropology & archaeology), readability, having specific connections to the course materials [readings, films, lectures, discussions, etc.], and completeness & cogency, not word count. • From your answers, I want to be confident that you have been completing the assignments and have been through all of the course materials...show me that you have taken this course, in particular. It will be clear if you have not been keeping up with the course materials and/or not participating in lab sections. 6 -- 6 of 16 -- • Because generative AI can readily produce large amounts of information, simply providing more content does not demonstrate learning. High-quality

exam responses synthesize relevant evidence rather than compiling it. Students should focus on answering the question directly by integrating course concepts, examples, and terminology into a coherent argument that demonstrates an understanding of how the material fits together, rather than presenting disconnected facts or exhaustive summaries. • SEE ALSO THE AI USE INFORMATION BELOW, which is important for how I grade everything in this course. • FINAL EXAM (2 hours) - see the course schedule below for date/time • 15-20 multiple choice & true/false questions • Utilize the weekly quizzes (most of the questions will come directly from the weekly quizzes), lectures, readings, & films, and study questions (in the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS) to prepare for this section of the exam. • 3 essay questions • Utilize the lab section exercises & discussions, lectures, readings, & films, and study questions (in the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS) to prepare for this section of the exam. • Suggested length that an average student needs to properly answer a short essay is approximately 500-800 words PER ESSAY QUESTION, but note that credit is based on content quality, use of professional language

Course Schedule (high-level)

- Week 1 (AUG. 24-30): Welcome! Course overview & instructor introduction. | NO QUIZ
- Week 2 (AUG. 31-SEPT. 6): Welcome! Course overview & instructor introduction.
- Week 3 (SEPT. 7-13): The Principles of Archaeology & What is Anthropology?
- Week 4 (SEPT. 14-20): The History of Archaeology, Our Earliest Ancestors, Data Sampling Strategies,
- Week 5 (SEPT. 21-27): Making a Living-Foraging to Agriculture & The Paleolithic
- Week 6 (SEPT. 28-OCT. 4): Making a Living-Foraging to Agriculture & The Paleolithic
- Week 7 (OCT. 5-11): Thinking Critically About Context Building Behaviors & the Archaeology of | NO QUIZ
- Week 8 (OCT. 12-18): | NO QUIZ | NO CLASSES
- Week 9 (OCT. 19-25): Week 8 (ONLINE) MIDTERM EXAM NO QUIZ THIS WEEK
- Week 10 (OCT. 26-NOV. 1): States and Empires in Asia and Africa (continued)
- Week 11 (NOV. 2-8): States and Empires in Asia and Africa (continued)
- Week 12 (NOV. 9-15): Putting It All Together: From Research Questions to Research Outcomes
- Week 13 (NOV. 16-22): FILM DAY 3 - Authenticity, Tourism, & Heritage Studies
- Week 14 (NOV. 23-29): THANKSGIVING BREAK NO QUIZ THIS WEEK | NO CLASSES
- Week 15 (NOV. 30-DEC. 6): THANKSGIVING BREAK NO QUIZ THIS WEEK | NO QUIZ

Full Syllabus Extract

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